LOW-WASTE HOME

Buy, Repair, Borrow or Wait

A one-page decision planner for purchases you are unsure about.

Printable PDF · A4 and US Letter · low-ink edition

7 pages including cover
Digital download. Printable PDF. Not editable.

START HERE

Before you decide

Ask first: do I already own something that does this job?

1. Describe the need.
2. Choose your options.
3. Note the total cost and expected use.
4. Wait, then decide.

"Unknown" is a valid answer. If you do not know something, write it down rather than guessing.

DECISION TREE

Which route?

- [ ] I already own something that works: use it
- [ ] It just needs fixing: repair
- [ ] I need it only once: borrow or hire
- [ ] A used version is fine: buy used
- [ ] A new one is needed: buy new, after the wait

My route

COMPARE

Comparison worksheet

Option	Purchase or repair cost	Running cost	Expected uses	Cost per use	What I do not know yet

WAIT

7-day and 30-day review

Item	Date added	Review on (7 days)	Still want it? (Y/N)	Review on (30 days)	Still want it? (Y/N)

EXAMPLES

Worked examples

COMPLETED EXAMPLE

Small recurring purchase: a kitchen cleaner

Total cost over a year: £18 across 12 bottles. Use: weekly. Cost per use: about 35p. Refill option: available. Decision: buy a concentrate and refill.

COMPLETED EXAMPLE

Durable item: a cast iron pan

Cost: £40. Expected use: several times a week for many years. Cost per use: low over time. Decision: buy, after checking that the pan you already own does not do the job.

NOTES

My decision

Decision and reason

What I am still unsure about

This planner helps you decide. It does not score products for environmental impact.

YOUR DOWNLOAD

What is in your download

- [ ] buy-repair-borrow-or-wait-letter.pdf: Buy, Repair, Borrow or Wait, US Letter print edition
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